

WORSHIP RITUALS



The objective of the religion is purification of the soul. Attainment of excellence in this purification relies on a person's relationship of servitude with the Almighty on right footings. The stronger this relationship, the greater a person is able to achieve purification both in his concepts and in his deeds. Love, fear, sincerity, faithfulness and gratitude as an acknowledgement of His countless favours and blessings are the inner manifestations of this relationship.

I. THE PRAYER

- إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ كَانَتْ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ كِتَابًا مَوْقُوتًا

Indeed, the prayer is a duty incumbent on the faithful to be discharged at appointed hours.
(4:103)

The most important worship ritual of Islam is the prayer. A little deliberation shows that the essence of religion is comprehension of God and an expression of humility and servility before Him. The most prominent expression of this essence is worship. Invoking and glorifying Him, praising and thanking Him and kneeling and prostrating before Him are the practical manifestations of worship. The prayer is nothing but an expression of these manifestations and, with graceful poise, combines all of them

I. IMPORTANCE OF THE PRAYE

- The Foremost Directive – Tauheed & Prayer
- A Requisite for Muslim Citizenship
- Means of Strong Adherence to Islam
- As Eraser of Sins
- Means of Countering Hardships
- Means of Perseverance on the Truth

OBJECTIVE OF THE PRAYER

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا أَذْكُرُوا اللَّهَ ذِكْرًا كَثِيرًا

وَسَبِّحُوهُ بُكْرَةً وَأَصِيلًا

(Believers! Celebrate the praises of Allah in abundance and glorify Him morning and evening, (33:41 - 42))

HOW TO AVOID LAZINESS IN PRAYER?

- Full understanding of the importance of prayer
- Remaining vigilant in remembering Allah
- Protection from latent thoughts by seeking refuge of Allah
- Words of prayers in audible manner
- Purity of thoughts

2. ZAKAT

وَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ وَأَقْرِضُوا اللَّهَ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا وَمَا تُقَدِّمُوا لِأَنفُسِكُمْ مِنْ خَيْرٍ تَجِدُوهُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ هُوَ خَيْرًا وَأَعْظَمَ أَجْرًا ۚ وَاسْتَغْفِرُوا اللَّهَ ۖ إِنَّ اللَّهَ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ

And [in the daytime and at night] be diligent in the prayer and pay zakah and [for the cause of your religion and state] lend to Allah a befitting loan, and [remember] whatever good you send forth for yourselves you shall find it with Allah better than before and greater in reward. (73:20)

After the *salah* (the prayer), it is the second important worship ritual in Islam. Among the various mannerisms which man has generally adopted to worship deities, one is to present before them a part of their wealth, livestock and produce. In the religion of the prophets, this is the essence of *zakah*, and on this very basis, it is has been regarded as a ritual of worship. Names like *sadaqah*, *niyadh*, *bhint* and *nadhr* are also used for it.

- الَّذِينَ يُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَيُؤْتُونَ الزَّكَاةَ وَهُمْ رُكَّعُونَ

Those who are diligent in the prayer, pay zakah such that [their hearts] bow [down in humility]. (5:55)

وَالَّذِينَ يُؤْتُونَ مَا آتَوْا وَقُلُوبُهُمْ وَجِلَةٌ أَنَّهُمْ إِلَى رَبِّهِمْ رَاجِعُونَ

And those who whenever give, give such that their hearts are filled with awe knowing that they will have to return to their Lord. (23:60)

The importance of this ritual of worship can be understood from the fact that like the prayer the Almighty has regarded it as a pre-requisite for a person to be a Muslim. The Qur'an says: (so if they repent, become diligent in the prayer and pay *zakah*, they are your brethren in religion, (9:11)). It is evident from the Qur'an that after the prayer, it is the second manifestation of faith.

HEADS OF ZAKAT

إِنَّمَا الصَّدَقَتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ وَالْمَسْكِينِ وَالْعَمَلِينَ عَلَيْهَا وَالْمُؤَلَّفَةِ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَفِي الرِّقَابِ وَالْغَرَمِينَ وَفِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَأَبْنِ السَّبِيلِ طَرِيقَةً
مِّنَ اللَّهِ ۖ وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ

Zakah is only for the poor and the needy, and for those who are 'amils over it, and for those whose hearts are to be reconciled [to the truth], and for the emancipation of the slaves and for those who have been inflicted with losses and for the way of Allah and for the welfare of the wayfarers. This is an obligation decreed by God and God is All-Knowing and Wise. (9:60)

1. Poor and Needy
2. Salaries of the employees of the state
3. All political expenditure in the interest of Islam and Muslims
4. For liberation from slavery of all kinds
5. For helping people who are suffering economic losses, or burdened with a fine or loan
6. For serving Islam and for the welfare of Muslims
7. For helping travelers